

PROGRAMMING FOR PROBLEM SOLVING (BE01000121)



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CHAPTER-9

DYNAMIC MEMORY

ALLOCATION

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ROADMAP

- ❑ Introduction to Dynamic memory allocation,
- ❑ malloc() calloc(), realloc(), free() functions

STATIC VS DYNAMIC

static memory allocation

memory is allocated at compile time.

memory can't be increased while executing program.

used in array.

dynamic memory allocation

memory is allocated at run time.

memory can be increased while executing program.

used in linked list.

DYNAMIC MEMORY ALLOCATION

malloc()	allocates single block of requested memory.
calloc()	allocates multiple block of requested memory.
realloc()	reallocates the memory occupied by malloc() or calloc() functions.
free()	frees the dynamically allocated memory.

INTRODUCTION

- An array is a collection of a fixed number of values. Once the size of an array is declared, you cannot change it.
- Sometimes the size of the array you declared may be insufficient. To solve this issue, you can allocate memory manually during run-time. This is known as dynamic memory allocation in C programming.
- To allocate memory dynamically, library functions are `malloc()`, `calloc()`, `realloc()` and `free()` are used. These functions are defined in the `<stdlib.h>` header file.

MALLOC()

- "malloc" stands for memory allocation.
- The malloc() function reserves a block of memory of the specified number of bytes. And, it returns a pointer of void which can be casted into pointers of any form.

Syntax of malloc()

```
ptr = (castType*) malloc(size);
```


MALLOC()

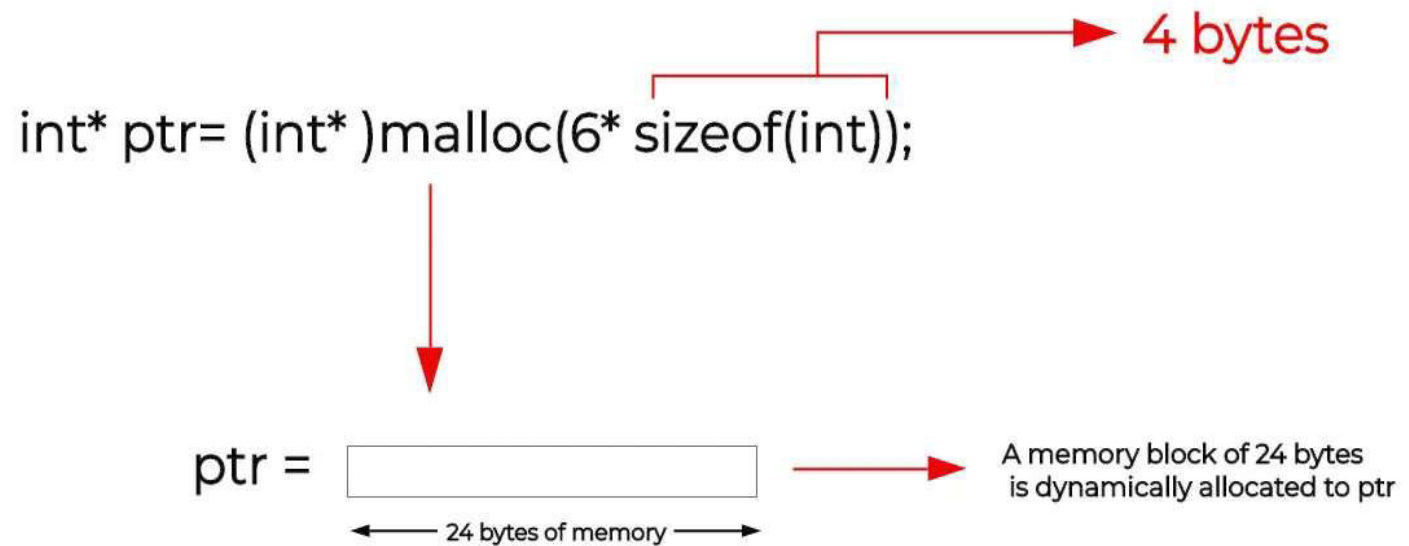
Example

```
ptr = (float*) malloc(100 * sizeof(float));
```

- The above statement allocates 400 bytes of memory. It's because the size of float is 4 bytes. And, the pointer ptr holds the address of the first byte in the allocated memory.
- The expression results in a NULL pointer if the memory cannot be allocated.

MALLOC()

Malloc()



MALLOC()

```
#include <stdio.h>
#include <stdlib.h>
```

```
int main()
{
    int n, i;
    int *ptr;
```

```
printf("Enter the number of
elements: ");
scanf("%d", &n);
```

```
// Allocate memory for 'n'
elements using malloc()
```

```
ptr = (int *)malloc(n *
sizeof(int));
```


MALLOC()

```
if (ptr == NULL) {  
    printf("Memory  
allocation failed.\n");  
    exit(1);  
}  
  
printf("Enter the  
elements: ");  
for (i = 0; i < n; i++)  
    scanf("%d", &ptr[i]);  
  
printf("The elements you  
entered are: ");  
for (i = 0; i < n; i++) {  
    printf("%d ", ptr[i]);  
}  
  
free(ptr);  
return 0;  
}
```

MALLOC()

```
Enter the number of elements: 3
```

```
Enter the elements: 1
```

```
2
```

```
3
```

```
The elements you entered are: 1 2 3
```


CALLOC()

- The name "calloc" stands for contiguous allocation.
- The malloc() function allocates memory and leaves the memory uninitialized, whereas the calloc() function allocates memory and initializes all bits to zero.
- calloc() is used to allocate multiple blocks of memory, typically to store an array of elements.

Syntax of calloc()

```
ptr = (castType*)calloc(n, size);
```

CALLOC()

Example:

```
ptr = (float*) calloc(25, sizeof(float));
```

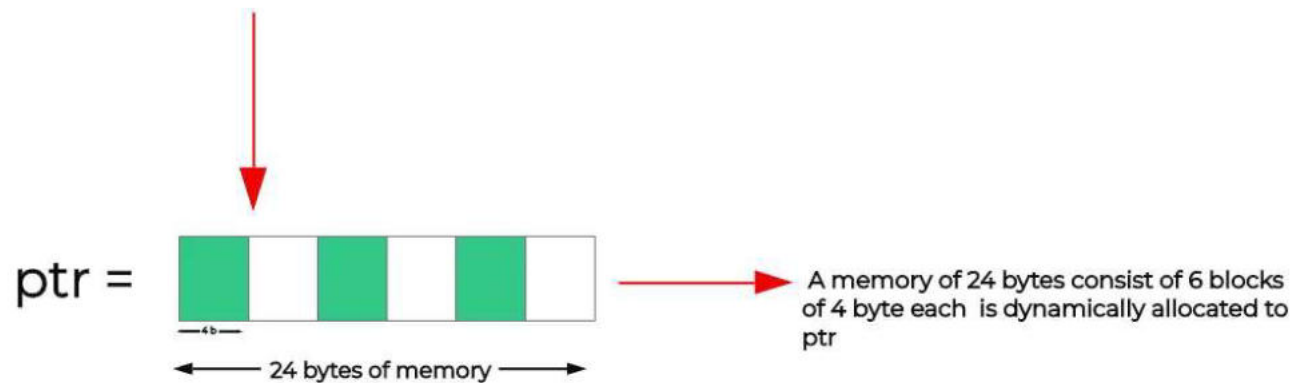
- The above statement allocates contiguous space in memory for 25 elements of type float.

CALLOC()

calloc()

```
int* ptr= (int* )calloc(6, sizeof(int));
```

4 bytes



CALLOC()

```
#include <stdio.h>
#include <stdlib.h>
```

```
int main()
{
    int n, i;
    int *ptr;
```

```
printf("Enter the number of
elements: ");
scanf("%d", &n);
```

```
// Allocate memory for 'n'
elements using malloc()
```

```
ptr = (int *)calloc(n,
sizeof(int));
```


CALLOC()

```
if (ptr == NULL) {  
    printf("Memory  
allocation failed.\n");  
    exit(1);  
}  
  
printf("Enter the  
elements: ");  
for (i = 0; i < n; i++)  
    scanf("%d", &ptr[i]);  
  
printf("The elements you  
entered are: ");  
for (i = 0; i < n; i++) {  
    printf("%d ", ptr[i]);  
}  
  
free(ptr);  
return 0;  
}
```

CALLOC()

```
Enter the number of elements: 3
```

```
Enter the elements: 34
```

```
76
```

```
89
```

```
The elements you entered are: 34 76 89
```


FREE()

- Dynamically allocated memory created with either `calloc()` or `malloc()` doesn't get freed on their own.
- You must explicitly use `free()` to release the space.

Syntax of `free()`

```
free(ptr);
```

REALLOC()

- If the dynamically allocated memory is insufficient or more than required, you can change the size of previously allocated memory using the `realloc()` function.

Syntax of `realloc()`

```
ptr = realloc(ptr, x);
```


REALLOC()

```
#include <stdio.h>
#include <stdlib.h>

int main()
{
    ptr = (int*) malloc(n1 *
sizeof(int));

    printf("Addresses of
previously allocated
memory:\n");
    for(i = 0; i < n1; ++i)
        printf("%u\n", ptr + i);
}
```

REALLOC()

```
printf("\nEnter the new size:
");
scanf("%d", &n2);
// relocating the memory
ptr = realloc(ptr, n2 *
sizeof(int));
printf("Addresses of newly
allocated memory:\n");

for(i = 0; i < n2; ++i)
printf("%u\n", ptr + i);
free(ptr);
return 0;
}
```


REALLOC()

```
Enter size: 4
```

```
Addresses of previously allocated memory:
```

```
12847808
```

```
12847812
```

```
12847816
```

```
12847820
```

```
Enter the new size: 6
```

```
Addresses of newly allocated memory:
```

```
12847808
```

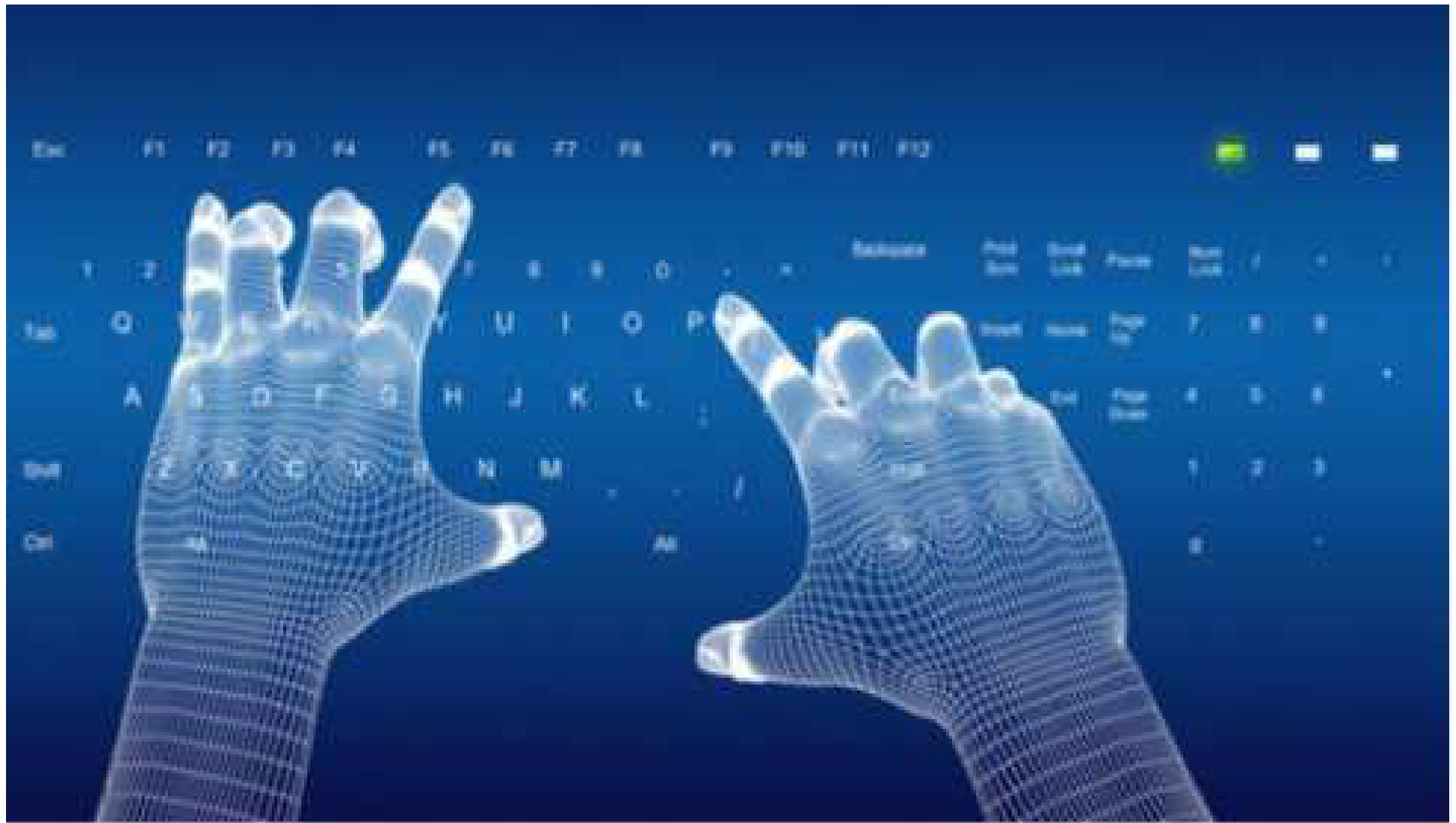
```
12847812
```

```
12847816
```

```
12847820
```

```
12847824
```

```
12847828
```



Thank You !